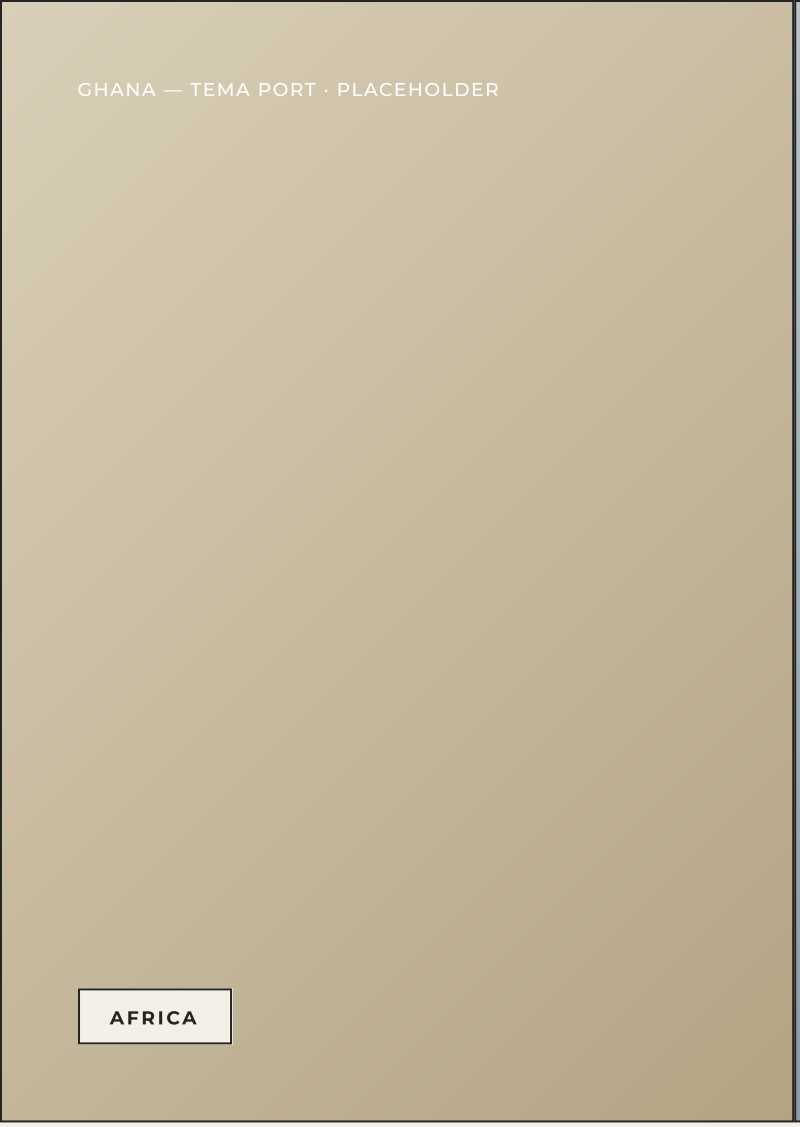




AN INVESTIGATIVE EDITORIAL JOURNAL · ISSUE 01 · 2026

Africa & Asia: Why Did Their Economic Paths Diverge?

A six-country investigation across sixty years. Six cases, three anchor years, three group hypotheses — and the counterexamples that refuse the easy answer.

GHANA · BOTSWANA · MAURITIUS · SOUTH KOREA · MALAYSIA · PHILIPPINES

SECTION A · THE QUESTION

Was slower growth caused by culture, or was culture itself shaped by history and institutions?

TOPIC (ASSIGNED)
Economic development in Africa: why this region couldn't grow like the Asia region — cultural analysis.

The assigned title asserts a conclusion. We treat it as a question. Six locked cases — Ghana, Botswana, Mauritius, South Korea, Malaysia, the Philippines — are observed at three anchor years: 1960, 1990, 2020. Three group hypotheses are then tested against that evidence. Culture may matter, but only through mechanisms the evidence can actually support.

Method · Observe → Predict → Test → Revise

VERB	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
Observe	Record what the six economies looked like at 1960, 1990 and 2020 using one harmonised dataset.
Predict	Write what each hypothesis would need to see if it were true.
Test	Compare against six cases, not two blocs; register supports and challenges.
Revise	Narrow, broaden, or reject the hypothesis based on what the evidence allows.

Contents

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2	The question & the route
3–4	1960 baseline · divergence
5–9	Colonial inheritance
10–13	The Asian turn & the Ghana / Korea pair
14–17	Culture, trust, authority — in context
18–22	Three hypotheses · the counterexamples
23–25	Synthesis · what travels · sources

WHAT THIS MAGAZINE CANNOT DO

It cannot identify a cause from six cases. It cannot assign country averages to individuals. It can, however, show which cultural stories survive contact with six economies observed at three anchor years, and which do not.

NOTE Anchor years locked by project control, 2026-09-22. All indicator values are drawn from the World Bank World Development Indicators release of 2026-07-13 (SRC-WDI-001). Three hypotheses are original group ideas developed for this project; they are not established academic theories.

In 1960, Ghana and South Korea were close — six cases were not two blocs.

ANCHOR
1960

UNIT
constant 2015 US$ per person

FIVE-SECOND ENTRY

The matched pair that re-starts the whole conversation

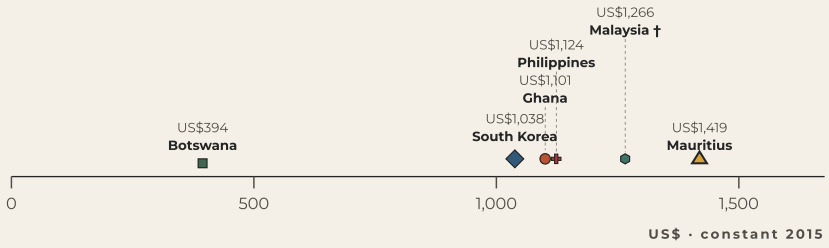
Ghana · 1960

US$1,101 ↔

South Korea · 1960

US$1,038

A gap of US$63 — within the measurement noise of the series.



† Malaysia 1960 is a retrospective territorial series that pre-dates the 1963 federation and Singapore's 1965 exit; it is shown with a dagger throughout. Observed anchors only — no values are estimated between dated observations.

WHAT THE BASELINE SHOWS

The paired fact is simple: Ghana and South Korea were within US$63 of one another in 1960. The spread between the six cases was already wider than many Africa / Asia narratives allow.

WHAT IT DOES NOT PROVE

Starting positions are not destinies. The chart identifies no cause. Education, agriculture, infrastructure, policy and international conditions still have to be examined. Mauritius leads this group yet is African; Botswana is lowest and converges rapidly later.

WHAT IS NOT HERE

A 1960 literacy ranking is deliberately absent: definitions and ages differ and Ghana's observation is unresolved. One number cannot stand for "starting conditions."

NOTE GDP per capita in constant 2015 US$ (market-exchange basis). *Data from* World Development Indicators (NY.GDP.PCAP.KD), by World Bank (2026); lastupdated=2026-07-13. Values plotted for 1960 only. Gaps do not identify whether culture, policy, institutions, war, aid, or any other factor caused them.

What diverged — and what did not?

INDICATORS
GDP per capita · sector employment · manufacturing share of GDP

Change differs by indicator and country. GDP per person moved sharply in Korea and Botswana, slowly in the Philippines; manufacturing share rose in some, fell in others; agricultural employment collapsed in some, lingered in others. One continent cannot explain any of it.

Ghana

1960 → 2020

GDP p.c.	×1.79
Agric. emp.	71.8→37.4%
Mfg. (% GDP)	9.8→11.0%

1965 † proxy on manufacturing. Reallocation out of farming did not deepen manufacturing.

Botswana

1960 → 2020

GDP p.c.	×15.9
Agric. emp.	12.6→19.4%*
Mfg. (% GDP)	11.6→5.7%

Fastest income growth of the six — without manufacturing deepening. *1991 proxy for first point.

Mauritius

1960 → 2020

GDP p.c.	×6.7
Agric. emp.	19.6→5.3%*
Mfg. (% GDP)	20.4→10.7%**

Rose through EPZ, now diversified into tourism and finance. **1990 → 2020 only (1960 absent).

South Korea

1960 → 2020

GDP p.c.	×32.0
Agric. emp.	15.5→5.4%*
Mfg. (% GDP)	11.4→25.7%

Largest income increase of the six. Manufacturing more than doubled as a share of GDP.

Malaysia

1960 → 2020

GDP p.c.	×8.0 †
Agric. emp.	18.9→10.4%*
Mfg. (% GDP)	10.3→22.2%

Peaked at 30.9% manufacturing in 1999, since softened; multinational-led electronics dominates exports.

Philippines

1960 → 2020

GDP p.c.	×2.85
Agric. emp.	44.1→24.5%*
Mfg. (% GDP)	17.7% (2020 only)

Only 2020 manufacturing share is current WDI; earlier vintages are narrative-only and are not connected.

WHAT THESE MULTIPLES CANNOT PROVE

Movements on the three indicators tell different stories about "development." GDP, employment, productivity and manufacturing are not interchangeable; one of them rising does not demand another follow.

SOURCES GDP per capita (NY.GDP.PCAP.KD) · sector employment (SL.AGR/IND/SRV.EMPL.ZS, ILO modelled; 1991 † proxy for 1990) · manufacturing (NV.IND.MANF.ZS). *Data from* World Development Indicators, World Bank (2026). Full figure plates on page 13 and in the figure archive.

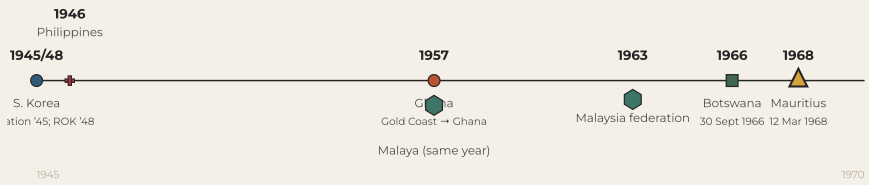
Colonialism changed the starting line — in six different ways.

INDEPENDENCE YEARS
1945/48 · 1946 · 1957 · 1963 · 1966 · 1968

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID	MAP-001 · colonial control, 1914
STATUS	**BLOCKED** — awaits a verified Library of Congress raster derivative (LoC item 2021668660; Linde & Wagner & Debes, *Africa*, 1914).
INTERIM	Dated chronology below replaces an unverified map. No invented geometry is used.
RIGHTS	"Free to use and reuse" on resolved retrieval; adaptation permitted with change notice.

Six transitions — different sequences, not one event



WHAT THE DATES SHOW

The six economies did not start running at the same time. Korea's 1945 liberation came with a divided peninsula and a war on the horizon; Botswana walked into 1966 with eight kilometres of tarred road.

WHAT THEY DO NOT SHOW

A date is not an inheritance. Ghana left 1957 with cocoa dependence *and* usable public and transport assets (World Bank, 1985, Report 5716-GH). The Philippines' 1946 institutions coexisted with land concentration.

WHAT WE REFUSE TO SAY

"Berlin drew Africa's borders" — rejected by Paine, Qiu & Ricart-Huguet (2025): 62% of 107 coded bilateral borders in Africa were affected by precolonial political frontiers. Partition happened; so did accommodation.

SOURCES Independence dates verified in RES-001 evidence pack (CTRL-record 2026-10-04). Jedwab & Moradi (2012); World Bank (1985) Report 5716-GH; Haggard, Kang & Moon (1997); Paine, Qiu & Ricart-Huguet (2025). Map asset blocked pending verified LoC raster retrieval.

“Not two boxes.” What different colonial systems actually did.

SCOPE
Six cases, four empires, inside-empire variation

Imperial flags do not explain institutional variation. The claim that British “indirect rule” was lighter, or that French “direct rule” was more extractive, flattens evidence that was always lumpy. Variation sat *inside* each empire, not between two neat boxes.

COMMON CLAIM	WHAT THE EVIDENCE SHOWS	WHAT IT CANNOT BE USED FOR
“Indirect rule” was uniform in British Africa.	A single chief appears in only 17% of coded British colonial units; councils, elders and multiple chiefs are more common (Bolt, Gardner, Kohler, Paine & Robinson, 2025).	Treating “indirect rule” as one institution or inferring Ghana’s or Botswana’s post-1960 trajectory from the label alone.
British and French public finance diverged sharply.	Both relied heavily on customs revenue; late-colonial per-capita spending rose in both; education expenditure patterns differed somewhat but not as sharply as narratives claim (Cogneau, Dupraz & Mesplé-Somps, 2018).	A single empire-level fiscal story. Nothing causal about post-independence growth paths follows.
French West Africa was uniformly under-invested.	District-level investment varied sharply and left persistent local associations with later outcomes (Huillery, 2009).	Treating an empire as an undifferentiated whole.
Japanese colonial rule built Korea’s developmental state.	Contested. Kohli (1994) stresses institutional continuity; Haggard, Kang & Moon (1997) stress disruption from division, war, land reform and post-1961 change.	“Japan created Korea’s miracle.” Independence was not continuous rule.
The Philippines inherited reformable institutions from the US period.	Formal institutions expanded alongside elite land concentration (Dolan, 1993, pending clean archival copy).	Reading post-1946 outcomes as a straightforward colonial legacy; many later policy choices were decisive.
Mauritius inherited a single colonial system.	Successive French and British layers, with indentured labour from India from the 1830s onwards (Mauritius National Archives Department, n.d.; UNESCO WHC, 2006, Aapravasi Ghat).	Collapsing Mauritius into either “French” or “British.” Later diversification is multi-source.

MECHANISM, NOT LABEL

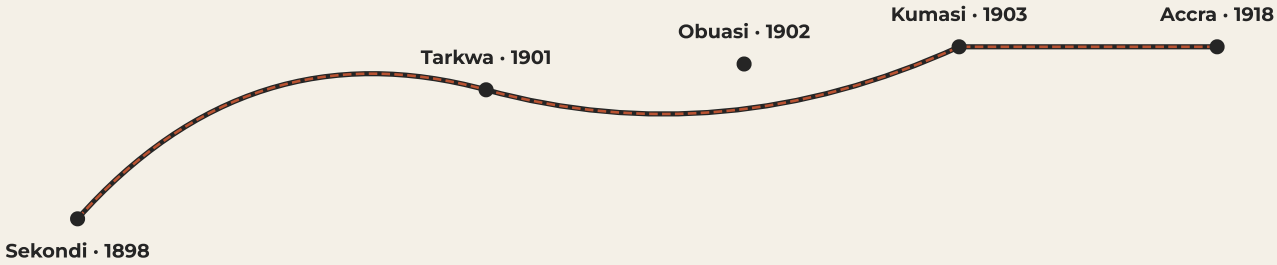
Colonial systems bequeathed specific assets (railway segments, trained administrators, export markets) and specific liabilities (concentration, extractive revenue mix, settler land holdings). Both often came through the same institution. The question is which combinations later mattered — and under which post-1960 policies.

SOURCES Bolt et al. (2025) NBER WP 30582; Cogneau, Dupraz & Mesplé-Somps (2018); Huillery (2009) *AEJ: Applied Economics*, 1(2); Kohli (1994) *WD*, 22(9); Haggard, Kang & Moon (1997) *WD*, 25(6); Dolan (1993); Mauritius National Archives (n.d.); UNESCO WHC (2006). RES-001 evidence pack.

A railway is four things at once — depending on which layer you look at.

CASE
Ghana colonial government railway, 1898–1918

The temptation is to read a line on a map as a benefit. Ghana's colonial-era railway was built, owned, used and remembered differently depending on the layer. Here we annotate the same original route in four layers at once — not reproducing the copyrighted source map, but rendering an original schematic from the facts Jedwab and Moradi (2012) establish.



LAYER 1

Built by / under

Colonial government of the Gold Coast. Construction was state-led, not private-settler. Chinese and local labour were employed on segments.

LAYER 2

Owned / administered by

Colonial government department (not a private railway company). Operating authority passed to Ghana at independence; corporate form evolved.

LAYER 3

Stated purpose

Open gold-mining districts (Tarkwa, Obuasi); link administration (Kumasi); carry cocoa to coast once production grew. Not a passenger-first system.

LAYER 4

Later use / effect

Served cocoa expansion; raised nearby population density; left persistent locational effects (Jedwab & Moradi, 2012) — not a universal welfare uplift.

WHAT THIS IMAGE IS

An original schematic drawn from stated facts and date-anchored stations. Not a reproduction or tracing of the copyrighted source map. Operator-segment labels are deliberately generic ("colonial government railway") where the registered evidence does not warrant more.

WHAT IT CANNOT PROVE

Infrastructure proximity is not infrastructure benefit. A line extends to a point; who travels and what travels and whose land it crosses are separate questions. "Afterlife" requires post-1960 investment to persist; many lines did not survive.

SOURCES Jedwab & Moradi (2012) *Colonial investments and long-term development in Africa: Ghanaian railways*; World Bank (1985) Report 5716-GH, printed p. 18 / PDF p. 27, paras. 1.01–1.03. Image: original schematic, Claude Opus editorial draft, 2026-10-12; redrawn from cited facts, not from the authors' figures.

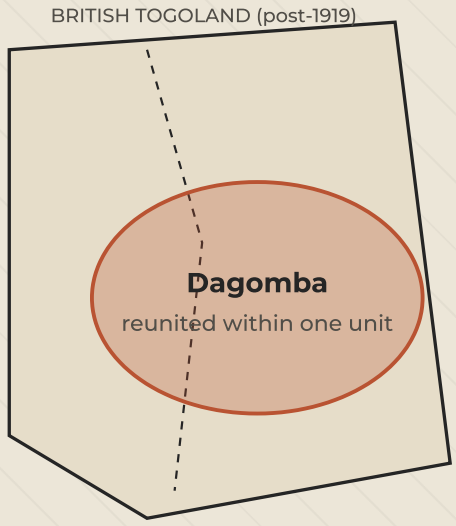
The same boundary — accommodation on one line, partition on another.

CASE
Ghana–Togo, 1919 (postwar demarcation)

Partition and accommodation can happen at the same border. Paine, Qiu and Ricart-Huguet (2025) show that the 1919 postwar settlement reunited the Dagomba within British Togoland while leaving the Ewe cultural area split between two polities. One line, two different relationships to pre-existing political frontiers.

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

RECONSTRUCTED MAP DETAIL — DAGOMBA

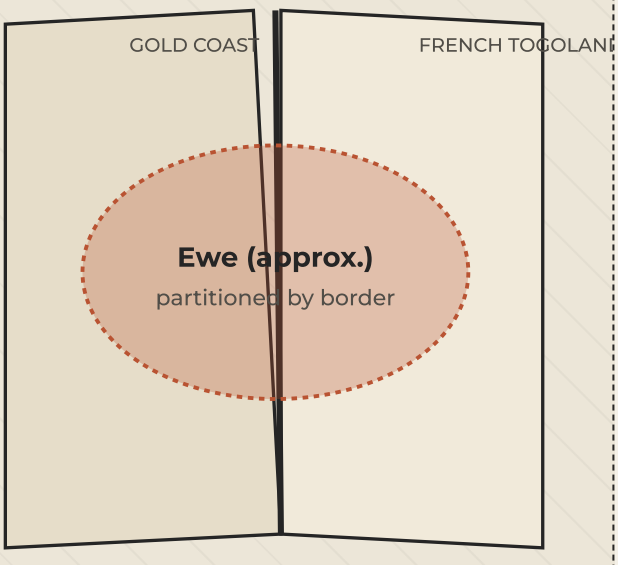


Outcome: accommodation. The 1919 revision brought the Dagomba cultural area together under one administrative unit, aligning it with a pre-existing political frontier.

Adapted from Paine, Qiu & Ricart-Huguet (2025), Figure 7d.

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

RECONSTRUCTED MAP DETAIL — EWE



Outcome: partition. The same postwar demarcation left the Ewe cultural area split between British and French administrations.

Dashed outline marks reconstructed Ewe extent; the authors flag the delineation as approximate and this

WHAT THIS COMPARISON CAN AND CANNOT PROVE

It cannot show that one outcome caused better development. It can show that a shorthand like “Berlin drew Africa’s borders” mislabels a lumpier process: 62% of 107 coded African bilateral borders in Paine et al. (2025) Table 1 are affected by precolonial political frontiers. Partition and accommodation are both outcomes to be explained.

SOURCES Paine, Qiu & Ricart-Huguet (2025) *Endogenous colonial borders*. *APSR*, 119(1). CC BY 4.0. Figures reconstructed to the article’s stated spatial extents; no raster of the original figure is reproduced. Michalopoulos & Papaioannou (2016) is referenced for later effects of partitioned homelands.

You are president in 1960. Allocate one hundred points.

RULE
The six amounts must sum to 100. There is no neutral default.

This spread is the static version of a classroom interaction. Choose how to spend a notional unit of public capacity between six priorities. There is no correct answer; there is no national constraint applied here. Compare your allocation to the (necessarily simplified) choices that four of our cases actually prioritised.

Primary education

Universal basic literacy and numeracy before advanced schools. Later supply curve of skilled workers.

__ points

Export-oriented factories & investment coordination

Credit tied to export performance; firm-level discipline; sequence of upgrading sectors.

__ points

Roads, ports and electricity

Reach markets, run factories, light homes. Expensive, slow, politically visible.

__ points

Public health & agricultural extension

Lower mortality and raise rural productivity before people move into cities.

__ points

Security & the rule of law

Courts, land registration, border administration. Hard to measure, easy to erode.

__ points

State capacity (civil service & statistics)

The quiet machinery that makes every other box legible. Hard to brand.

__ points

WHAT FOUR CASES ACTUALLY EMPHASISED (NECESSARILY SIMPLIFIED)

- **South Korea (1960s–70s):** primary education + land reform + export-linked credit + infrastructure.
- **Botswana (1966 onwards):** civil service + mineral revenue stewardship + public investment.
- **Mauritius (post-1970):** export processing zone + diversification into tourism and finance.
- **Ghana (1960s–80s):** import-substitution, cocoa dependence, repeated regime change.

WHY THIS IS A GAME, NOT A PREDICTION

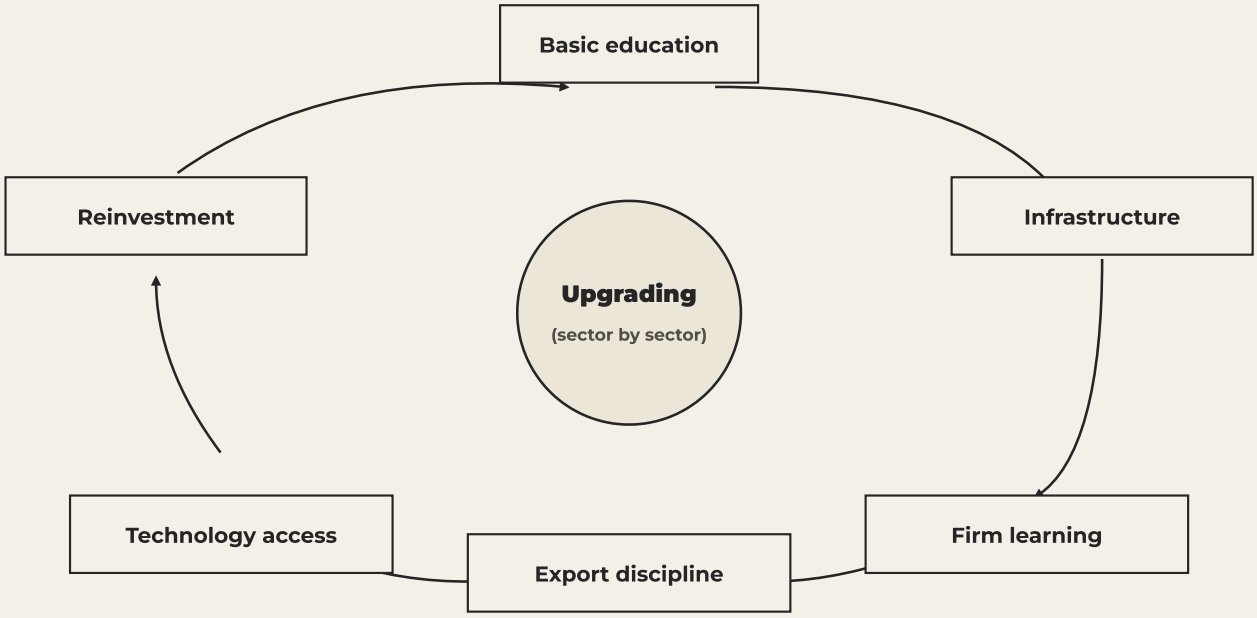
An allocation says nothing about what the state could actually do with the money, who paid, who received, or what the global economy allowed. Mauritius' EPZ needed US and European market access; Korea's HCI push depended on a security relationship. Policy is one input among many.

NOTE Classroom protocol requires an offline/static alternative to the interactive activity. This page is that alternative; the live interaction (GAME-001) remains deferred pending a documented platform, operator, timing and test plan. "Simplified" priorities are summaries, not citations; see pages 10 and 12 for the full capability-building story.

Capability compounds — when learning is disciplined by markets.

MECHANISM
Education → infrastructure → firms → exports → learning → reinvestment → upgrading

Industrial capability in Korea, Malaysia and Mauritius was not one lever but a loop. Each step raises the next: schooling expands the labour pool; infrastructure lowers the cost of production; export-linked credit disciplines firm learning; profits re-enter the loop as upgrading. The loop is not uniquely Asian — but it is uniquely demanding of coordination.



WHERE THIS FITS
Korea (1960–90) built the full loop. Malaysia built most of it with foreign direct investment. Mauritius built the sugar->textile->tourism->finance adaptation of it.

WHERE IT STRAINS
Botswana grew rapidly without a manufacturing loop — mineral revenue stewardship took its place. The Philippines produced large electronics export values without comparable firm-level deepening (Nasution, 2000; World Bank, 2020).

WHY CULTURE IS NOT SUFFICIENT
None of the arrows run through "values." Each depends on investment, policy, markets, discipline, and the international conditions of the day.

SOURCES World Bank (1993) *The East Asian Miracle*, pp. 20–26, 79–80, 127–130, 159–161; McMillan, Rodrik & Verduzco (2014) *WD*, 63, p. 11; Nasution (2000); World Bank (2020). Diagram: original editorial, Claude Opus draft, 2026-10-12.

Export categories hide what is actually inside the box.

PROJECT RULE
No six-country export-composition chart

Manufactured-export shares are not interchangeable with manufacturing value added, and they rarely tell us where the learning happened. Classifications shift (merchandise vs principal groups; HS vintages; re-exports counted or not). We can't draw a common six-country trend. We can register the per-case anchors — and name what each one does and does not establish.

CASE	ANCHOR	VALUE & SOURCE	WHAT IT ESTABLISHES · WHAT IT DOES NOT
Ghana	1959–62	Cocoa + products **≈60%** of export income (Government of Ghana, 1964, p. 224).	Establishes commodity dependence at independence. Does not fix exact 1960/1990/2020 product shares.
South Korea	1960	Primary 86.3% / manufactures 13.7% of US$32.8m exports (Kim, 1971, Table 1).	Shows how commodity-heavy Korea's 1960 exports were. Does not identify a cause of what followed.
Mauritius	1970 → 1996	Sugar **86% → 24%** of merchandise exports (World Bank, 1997).	Shows a specific merchandise diversification. Tourism and finance (now larger) are not merchandise.
Botswana	1990 vs 2020	Diamonds 78.8% (IMF, 1998) vs 88.2% (Statistics Botswana, 2021).	Shows diamond dominance both years. Classifications differ — *do not connect* as a trend.
Malaysia	1990	Manufactures **58.8%** of exports; crude petroleum 13.4% (IMF, 1999, Table IV.3).	Shows manufactured-export emergence. By 1992, almost 90% of electronic products were made by multinational affiliates (World Bank, 2020, Box 2).
Philippines	2020	Electronic products **58.2%** of merchandise exports (PSA, 2021).	Shows large electronics share. Does not show firm-level deepening; multinational-led assembly matters.

WHY THERE IS NO COMMON CHART

IMF 1990 principal groups and 2020 national principal groups use different classification systems; Mauritius' merchandise chart would omit tourism and finance (now the heart of the economy); the Philippines' manufacturing-share series across 1960/1990/2020 crosses incompatible vintages (only the 2020 WDI value is current).

WHAT EXPORTS DO NOT MEASURE

Share-of-exports does not measure value added at home, firm-level learning, or who captures the surplus. Headquarters and ownership matter.

A PRODUCT JOURNEY

An electronics good exported from the Philippines or Malaysia may be designed abroad, assembled with imported inputs, re-exported through regional hubs, and finally invoiced from a third country. The export line is the end of a long chain.

A DIRECT QUOTE WORTH KEEPING

"By 1992 almost 90% of electronic products in Malaysia were made by transnational-corporation affiliates."

— World Bank (2020), Box 2, pp. 44–47.

SOURCES Government of Ghana (1964); Kim (1971); World Bank (1997); IMF (1998, 1999); Statistics Botswana (2021); PSA (2021); Nasution (2000); World Bank (2020). ECON-001 evidence pack — approved claims A01–A07.

South Korea: capability built over time — not by culture alone.

RANGE
1948 – 2020

Korea’s income rose from US$1,038 in 1960 to US$33,216 in 2020 — a factor of thirty-two. The World Bank’s own analysis (1993) names the mechanisms: capability building, education, land reform, infrastructure, investment coordination, export-linked discipline, technology acquisition, aid, security guarantees, mistakes, and later adjustment. “Confucian culture” explains none of these on its own.

1948 – 1960

Postwar foundations

Land reform (1949–50) redistributes large holdings. US aid pays for food, textbooks, roads. Basic education expands. GDP per capita in 1960: **US$1,038**.

World Bank (1993) pp. 127–130; Haggard, Kang & Moon (1997).

1960S

Export push & discipline

Credit allocated against export targets; firm-level performance measured; infrastructure extended. Primary exports still dominate (86.3% in 1960; Kim, 1971) but shift.

Kim (1971); World Bank (1993) pp. 20–26.

1970S – 80S

HCI push, debt, adjustment

Heavy & chemical industries subsidised; rural electrification completed by 1979. Mistakes build up; 1980s adjustment prunes overcapacity. 1990 income: **US$9,673**.

World Bank (1993) pp. 159–161.

1990 – 2020

Upgrading & headwinds

Manufacturing share peaks (29.0% in 2011; still 25.7% in 2020). WGI Rule of Law 1.16 (2020). 2020 income **US$33,216** — **16.86×** Ghana’s.

WDI (2026); WGI (2026).

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID	ASSET-PH-KOR-GYEONGDONG-001
COUNTRY / PLACE	South Korea · Gyeongdong Market, Seoul
CREATOR / DATE	Gaël Chardon · 2008-04-21
SOURCE · LICENCE	Wikimedia Commons · CC BY-SA 2.0
ROLE	Everyday economic activity, 21st-century

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID	ASSET-PH-KOR-BUSAN-001
COUNTRY / PLACE	South Korea · Busan harbour
CREATOR / DATE	Svwmal · 2012-04-08
SOURCE · LICENCE	Wikimedia Commons · CC BY-SA 3.0
ROLE	Logistics infrastructure, 21st-century

WHAT KOREA IS — AND WHAT IT IS NOT

Korea is the strongest support for “durable direction with correction.” It is *not* evidence that a national culture drives growth. The same “Confucian” frame also covered South Korea during stagnation and across sharply different policy regimes.

SOURCES World Bank (1993) *The East Asian Miracle*; Haggard, Kang & Moon (1997); Kim (1971); WDI (2026). Images: Wikimedia Commons shortlist; placeholders used in draft pending final asset selection and crop/credit approval.

Near parity in 1960 became a 16.9-to-1 difference in 2020.

1960
US$1,101 / US$1,038

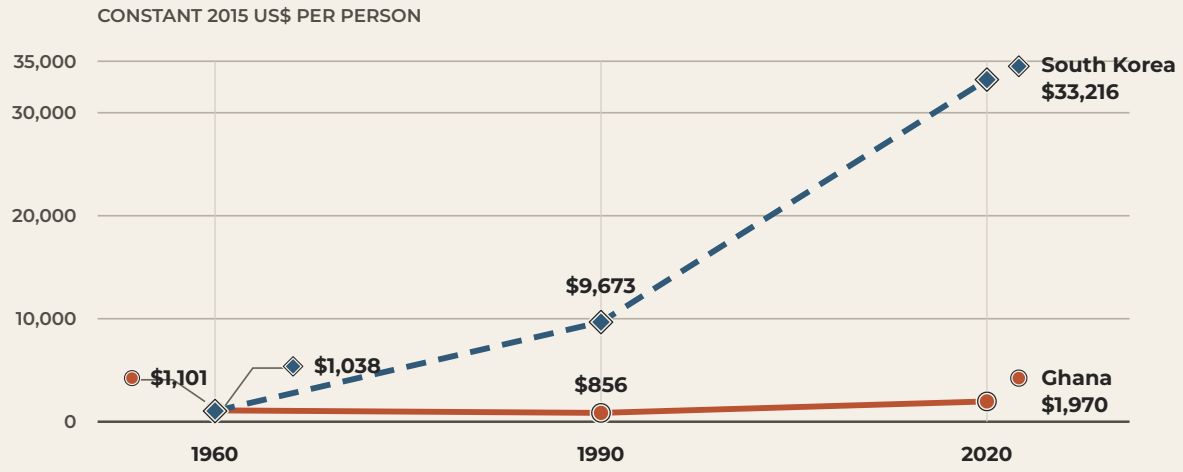
2020
US$1,970 / US$33,216

Two economies that were within US$63 of each other in 1960 ended 2020 roughly seventeen times apart. The pair is dramatic. It is also, by itself, no identification of a cause: two economies cannot run a controlled trial on sixty years. The chart below is a measurement, not an explanation. What explains the gap is the subject of pages 10–12 and the counterexamples on page 22.

GHANA × SOUTH KOREA · THREE OBSERVED ANCHORS

Near parity in 1960. Nearly 17-to-1 by 2020.

GDP per capita · constant 2015 US$ · 1960, 1990, and 2020



Observed anchors only.
Straight connectors guide the eye; they do not show or estimate annual values between the three years.

WHAT THE FIGURE SHOWS
Observed anchors only. Straight connectors join three dated observations and do not estimate values between years. 2020 is the COVID-19 year.

WHAT IT DOES NOT PROVE
Gaps do not identify whether culture, policy, institutions, war, aid, or any other factor caused them. The pair is a measurement — not a causal design.

WHY THE PAIR IS STILL USEFUL
It falsifies "Africa could not grow because of culture" — Botswana is African and grew faster per decade than most Asian cases on this chart.

FIGURE NOTE *Note.* GDP per capita in constant 2015 US dollars (market-exchange basis). *Data from World Development Indicators* (NY.GDP.PCAP.KD), by World Bank (2026); API lastupdated=2026-07-13. Values shown for 1960, 1990 and 2020. Source ID SRC-WDI-001; frozen CSV data/charts/ghana_korea_gdp_per_capita.csv.

Country averages are lenses, not personalities.

SCOPE
Six dimensions · but only three may be tested here

Hofstede himself warns against confusing national-level and individual-level inference. The six-country matrix also *cannot* be assembled: Botswana and Mauritius have no country rows; Ghana has only long-term orientation and indulgence/restraint. We split the six dimensions by what the evidence here can test and what it can only define.

TEST CONDITIONALLY

Three dimensions that connect to a plausible mechanism

DIMENSION	WHY IT IS TESTABLE HERE
Power distance (PDI)	Plausibly linked to coordination, trust across hierarchy, and legitimacy.
Individualism / collectivism (IDV)	Plausibly linked to firm scale, labour mobility, close-network trust.
Long-term orientation (LTO)	Plausibly linked to savings, patient investment, and firm learning cycles.

CONTEXT ONLY

Three dimensions this project does not use as development mechanisms

DIMENSION	WHY NOT HERE
Uncertainty avoidance (UAI)	Not a measure of risk aversion (Hofstede, 2011, pp. 9–10). Mechanisms to GDP not established in the registered evidence.
Masculinity / femininity (MAS)	Terminology aside, mechanisms to macro outcomes are not supported in approved claims.
Indulgence / restraint (IVR)	Treated as context, not a cause.

COUNTRY-LEVEL QUESTION • NOT PERSONALITY

Six-country passport — showing what is missing

COUNTRY	PDI	IDV	LTO	UAI	MAS	IVR
Ghana	—	—	4	—	—	72
Botswana	*No country row in official matrix.*					
Mauritius	*No country row in official matrix.*					
South Korea	60	18	100	85	39	29
Malaysia	100	26	41	36	50	57
Philippines	94	32	27	44	64	42

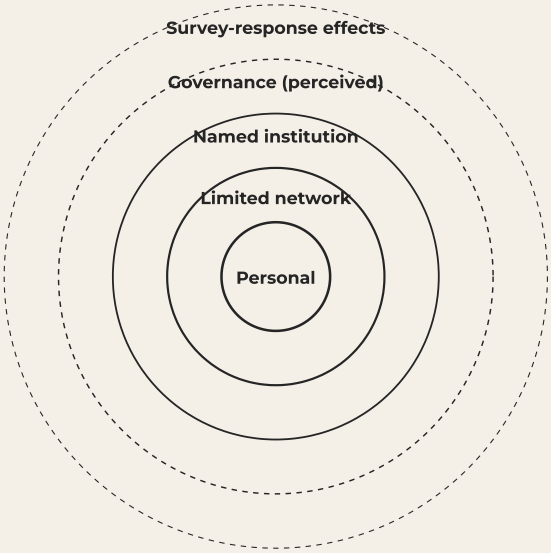
WHY THERE IS NO SIX-COUNTRY HOFSTEDE CHART
Three of the six countries lack usable country rows; regional aggregates (*Africa West*, *Africa East*) are not country substitutes. Any chart that filled the gaps would be fabricating evidence.

SOURCES Hofstede (2011) *Dimensionalizing cultures*, pp. 6–16; Hofstede (n.d.) country dimension matrix (version 2015-12-08); Brewer & Venaik (2014); McSweeney (2002); Beugelsdijk & Welzel (2018). RES-002 evidence pack.

“Trust” is five different things — and they are not on one scale.

TRAP
Collapsing institutions, perceptions and personal ties into one number.

The OECD (2017) explicitly distinguishes five constructs — generalized trust, limited-network trust, named-institution trust, governance (perceived), and survey-response effects. They are measured differently and move for different reasons. Averaging them, or plotting WGI as “trust,” misreads the evidence.



NOT ONE SCALE

WGI (2026) — governance composite with wide 90% CIs. Not direct trust.

Afrobarometer / Ipsos / WVS — named targets (banks, courts, president).

Direct trust measures (if available at all) are country-specific, year-specific, and often non-comparable in wording.

WHY WGI ≠ TRUST

Worldwide Governance Indicators are a perception-based governance composite, measured since 1996. The 2020 Rule-of-Law score is not a measure of how much citizens trust their neighbours.

WHY SIX-COUNTRY TRUST CHARTS FAIL

No matched 1960/1990 trust data exists for the six cases; the wording of “most people can be trusted” varies; small subsamples (e.g., 64/1,200 in WVS Philippines Wave 7) are not population estimates.

WHAT THIS DOES NOT RULE OUT

Institutional substitutes — contracts, courts, business associations — can plausibly extend cooperation beyond close ties. That is the one defensible form of “radius of trust.”

SOURCES OECD (2017) *Guidelines on measuring trust*, pp. 41–44, 66–79; World Bank (2026) WGI; Afrobarometer (Mauritius 2020, Botswana 2021); WVS Association (2024). RES-002 evidence pack.

Close networks can hold cooperation together — and also hold it back.

THEORY TESTED
Radius of Trust

Imagine a thousand dollars that must travel through other people before it reaches someone who will use it productively. Who do you hand it to first? The question is not academic. It is the start of a market: trust pays the frictions. The same close tie that lowers cost inside a group can also raise the cost of letting the outside in.

ANONYMOUS CLASSROOM POLL

Who would you trust with the money?

Choose *only* one. There is no correct answer. Your choice is read as a position, not an identity.

1. **A family member.**
2. **A member of the same ethnic or religious community.**
3. **A classmate you have known for less than a year.**
4. **A stranger with a signed contract.**
5. **A business association that will enforce rules on all members.**
6. **A government agency with public accounts.**

Static form of the group discussion GAME-002 (deferred). Running the live poll requires a platform/operator/time/ethics plan, a sample-size disclosure, and the explicit note that the result is a classroom reading — not a population estimate.

SUPPORT FOR COOPERATION
Close ties lower the cost of enforcement when every actor knows every other actor. They explain small-firm trading networks, remittances, and informal credit — observed in all six cases.

BOUNDARY AGAINST THE OUTSIDE
The same tie can slow hiring across groups, raise the cost of outside capital, and keep firms below efficient scale. “Collectivism” is not low trust; it is bounded trust.

INSTITUTIONAL SUBSTITUTE
Business associations, courts and public agencies can extend cooperation when close ties cannot. Mauritius’ EPZ worked because an export-processing authority adjudicated conflicts far outside family networks.

WHAT WE DO NOT SAY
No case here supports the strong claim that “generalized trust causes firm scale.” The project cell for Ghana and Korea is marked UNRESOLVED on this question.

SOURCES OECD (2017); Nunn & Wantchekon (2011) *AER*, 101(7); Afrobarometer; Ipsos (Malaysia 2020). Discussion protocol: static alternative only; live interaction (GAME-002) deferred.

Authority and time horizons are conditional mechanisms — the other three are not.

RULE
If / then / but — not "national personality"

POWER DISTANCE (PDI) — CONDITIONAL MECHANISM

If authority is centralised and legitimated, **then** coordinated investment can be imposed on firms (export discipline, HCI push, land reform), **but** if authority is captured or unaccountable, the same centralisation produces mis-allocation and rent extraction. Korea's HCI push works. The Philippines' Marcos-era centralisation does not. Same dimension; different conditions.

LONG-TERM ORIENTATION (LTO) — CONDITIONAL MECHANISM

If firms, households and the state have the fiscal space, information and incentives to think across cycles, **then** patient investment and savings follow, **but** if credit markets are shallow, inflation is high, or political survival is short-term, long-run plans are rational to reject. "Culture" does not override a 1980s debt crisis.

EVIDENCE INSUFFICIENT

Uncertainty avoidance (UAI)

Not a measure of risk aversion (Hofstede, 2011, pp. 9–10). No matched mechanism to development outcomes is registered in the approved claims.

EVIDENCE INSUFFICIENT

Masculinity / femininity (MAS)

Terminology aside, the registered evidence does not link country MAS scores to macro development outcomes.

EVIDENCE INSUFFICIENT

Indulgence / restraint (IVR)

Retained as context on p. 14 definitions strip. Not used as a causal mechanism in this project.

> **"Culture should enter only through specific, evidenced mechanisms — such as legitimacy, coordination, or organisational practice — and must compete with non-cultural explanations."**
>
> — Approved synthesis (ECON-001 recommendation).

WHAT WE REFUSE

"Confucian values" as a single cause of East Asian growth. "Hierarchical cultures" as a single cause of African stagnation. A grand culture explanation is cheap; the specific mechanism is expensive to establish. Pages 18–22 do that work.

SOURCES Hofstede (2011); Beugelsdijk & Welzel (2018); Brewer & Venaik (2014); McSweeney (2002); OECD (2017). RES-002 evidence pack. Pullquote: approved synthesis statement (ECON-001).

Do the three ideas survive the six-country evidence?

STANDARD
Mechanism · prediction · support · challenge · alternative · limitation

The three ideas tested here are our group's own hypotheses, not established academic theories. Each is bounded, matched against the six cases, and given a verdict: supported-with-exceptions, inconclusive, or supported-with-exceptions. The matrix opposite is the compact map; pages 19–21 are the full tests.

PAGE 18 · THREE-THEORY TEST · ORIGINAL GROUP HYPOTHESES

Three ideas vs six-country evidence.

Each original group hypothesis is tested against Ghana, Botswana, Mauritius, South Korea, Malaysia, and the Philippines: verdict, strongest support, strongest challenge, limitation, and the condition that would revise or reject.

READ A COLUMN: 1 Verdict · 2 Six country cells · 3 Star support
4 Cross challenge · 5 Limitation · 6 Revise/reject if

THEORY 1
Connected Development

SUPPORTED WITH EXCEPTIONS

SIX-COUNTRY TEST

- ● **Ghana** Consistent, not causal
- ■ **Botswana** Strong exception ✕
- ▲ **Mauritius** Support with conditions
- ◆ **South Korea** Multi-causal support
- ⬣ **Malaysia** Qualified support ★
- ✚ **Philippines** Counter to sufficiency

★ **STRONGEST SUPPORT** — **Malaysia**
Infrastructure, skills, firms, and world markets joined. TNC share ~90% electronics 1992.

✕ **STRONGEST CHALLENGE** — **Botswana**
Income gains with weakly connected inheritance; narrow manufacturing and exports.

LIMITATION
Cannot establish whether infrastructure led growth or

THEORY 2
Radius of Trust (substitutes form)

INCONCLUSIVE

SIX-COUNTRY TEST

- ● **Ghana** Unresolved
- ■ **Botswana** Mechanism plausible
- ▲ **Mauritius** Substitutes qualified ★
- ◆ **South Korea** Unresolved channel
- ⬣ **Malaysia** Plausible substitutes
- ✚ **Philippines** Counter to strong form ✕

★ **STRONGEST SUPPORT** — **Mauritius**
Institutions extended trust beyond close ties. Does not prove trust caused scaling.

✕ **STRONGEST CHALLENGE** — **Philippines**
Scaling with institutional substitutes. 2019 WVS cannot be back-cast or test channel.

LIMITATION
Only WGI covers all six. Trust data differ by target

THEORY 3
Continuity + Adaptation

SUPPORTED WITH EXCEPTIONS

SIX-COUNTRY TEST

- ● **Ghana** Unresolved direct test
- ■ **Botswana** Accumulation warning ✕
- ▲ **Mauritius** Strong qualified support
- ◆ **South Korea** Duration plus correction ★
- ⬣ **Malaysia** Moderate qualified support
- ✚ **Philippines** Support with warning

★ **STRONGEST SUPPORT** — **South Korea**
Duration, discipline, correction within a multi-causal sequence. Exports vs investment open.

✕ **STRONGEST CHALLENGE** — **Botswana**
Centralised rents with narrow exports and weak industry. Rents stronger than continuity.

LIMITATION
Cases cannot isolate duration from capacity, rents, demand

FIGURE NOTE *Note.* Theory evidence matrix. Three group hypotheses by six countries. Pattern-based verdict badges: hatched = supported-with-exceptions; dashed open = inconclusive. *Data from* approved claims in research/claim_registry.csv and the three evidence packs (RES-001, RES-002, ECON-001). Source ID VIS-005; frozen CSV data/charts/theory_evidence_matrix.csv.

Test 1 · Connected Development

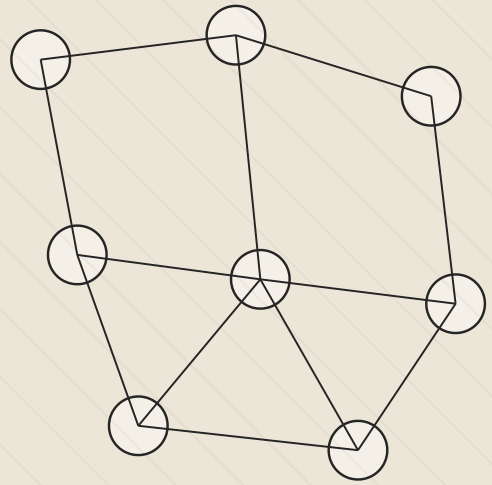
SUPPORTED-WITH-EXCEPTIONS

QUESTION
Not how much infrastructure existed — but whom it connected.

Keep only the "productive network depth" version: economies grow where infrastructure, firms, learning and markets are joined into deep productive networks. The claim *fails* if large income gains occur without productive networks — and *also* fails if deep network connection coexists with shallow upgrading.

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

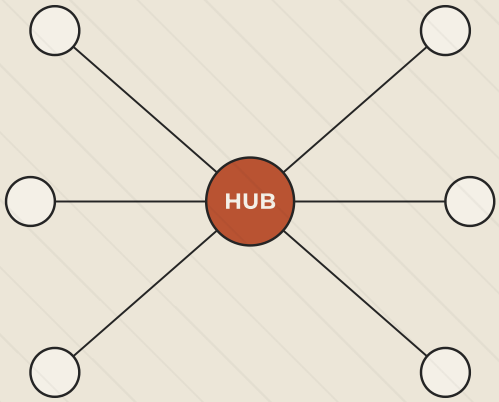
DEEP PRODUCTIVE NETWORK — SCHEMATIC



Many short, redundant links between firms, suppliers, workers and markets. Learning accumulates. Shocks spread through alternatives.

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

SHALLOW HUB — SCHEMATIC



Dense value at one node (a mine, a port, a multinational assembly line). High export share possible with limited domestic learning.

Six-case verdicts

CASE	VERDICT	WHY
Malaysia	**Strongest support**	Deep multinational-assembly networks with gradual domestic deepening (World Bank 2020).
Botswana	**Strongest challenge**	Fast income growth without inherited infrastructure or deep productive networks.
Philippines	Counterexample to sufficiency	Large electronics exports; shallow domestic linkages (Nasution 2000).
South Korea	Support with alternatives	Deep networks exist, but policy / aid / security also plausibly explain upgrading.
Mauritius	Support with conditions	EPZ built new networks — but tourism and finance expanded on different infrastructure.
Ghana	Consistent, non-causal	Reallocation out of agriculture without manufacturing deepening is consistent with the theory but does not identify a cause.

SOURCES World Bank (2020); McMillan, Rodrik & Verduzco (2014); Nasution (2000); IMF (1999); Jedwab & Moradi (2012). THEORY-002 approved claims. The theory stands only as productive-network-depth; the strong infrastructure-inheritance version is rejected by Botswana.

Test 2 · Radius of Trust

INCONCLUSIVE

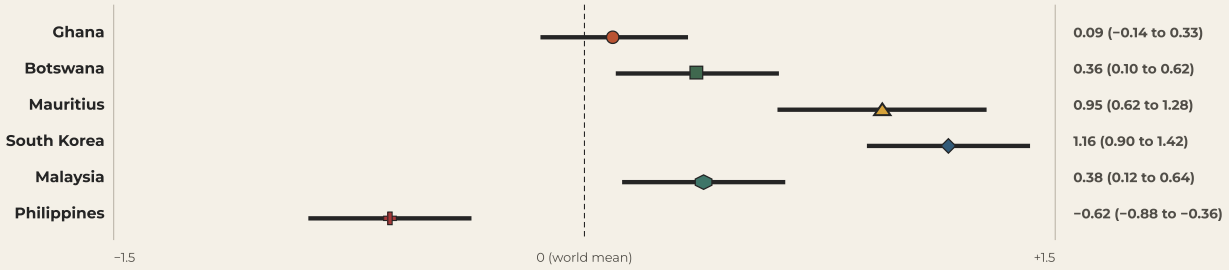
QUESTION
How far beyond close networks can economic trust travel?

The strong version — *generalized trust causes firm scale* — is rejected. The revised version — *institutions and organisations can plausibly substitute for low generalized trust* — is defensible but the project has no matched historical six-country trust evidence to test it decisively. Inconclusive is a verdict, not a shrug.

Evidence ladder — not every rung is comparable

RUNG	EXAMPLE SOURCE	CAN WE USE IT TO COMPARE SIX CASES?
1 · Direct trust (generalised)	WVS Q57 wording — but samples differ, years differ, four of six absent or sparse	**NO** — no common chart permitted
2 · Named-institution trust	Afrobarometer / Ipsos / local surveys for 2019–2021	Only as narrative, target by target
3 · Institutional substitutes	Business associations, EPZ authorities, courts	Yes — but with care; qualitative only
4 · Governance perceptions (WGI)	World Bank 2026 WGI release	Yes for 2020, with 90% CIs — *not as "trust"*
5 · Survey-response effects	OECD (2017)	Cannot compare across cases

What WGI 2020 Rule of Law says — with its 90% confidence intervals



WHAT THIS DOES AND DOES NOT ESTABLISH

It establishes governance perceptions in 2020 with wide 90% CIs. It does not establish generalized trust; it does not identify any 1960 or 1990 position; it is not a "trust" ranking.

WHERE THE THEORY REMAINS DEFENSIBLE

Institutional substitutes — Mauritius' EPZ authority, Korea's state banks, Malaysia's SME programmes — plausibly extended cooperation beyond close networks. The strong "low culture of trust" story is not supported here.

SOURCES World Bank (2026) *Worldwide Governance Indicators*, Rule of Law, 2020, with reported 90% CIs; OECD (2017); Afrobarometer; Ipsos (Malaysia 2020); WVS Association (2024). *Not* a direct trust measure.

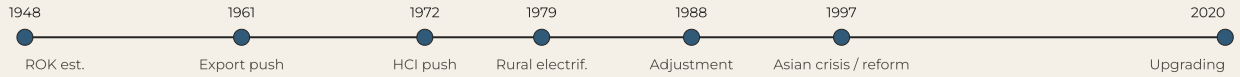
Test 3 · Continuity + Adaptation

SUPPORTED-WITH-EXCEPTIONS

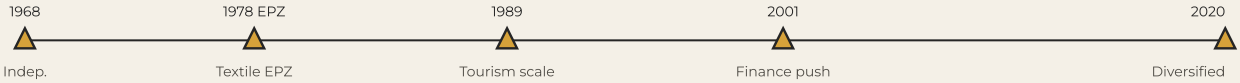
QUESTION
Can a country learn industrially if direction changes every few years?

Durable direction matters only when paired with performance feedback, correction and capability building. Continuity without discipline produces entrenched failure; policy churn without durable direction prevents learning. The verdict is *supported with exceptions*, not *supported*.

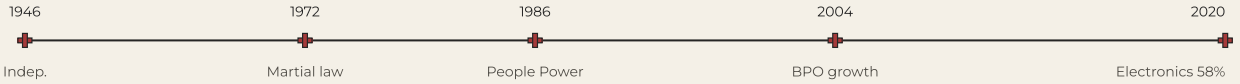
South Korea · strongest support · durable export discipline with mid-course correction



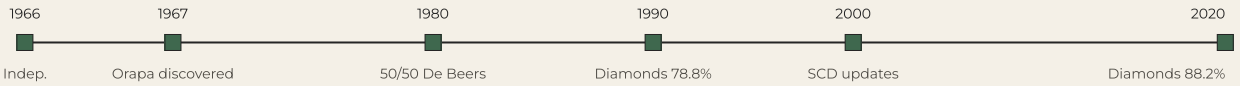
Mauritius · strong qualified support · deliberate sector-by-sector adaptation



Philippines · continuity-without-discipline warning



Botswana · accumulation-vs-diversification warning · the strongest challenge



THE EXCEPTION THAT TEACHES

Botswana shows that durable direction (prudent mineral stewardship for sixty years) can produce high incomes without diversification. Continuity is not enough; adaptation into new sectors is also required if the aim is manufacturing deepening. Direction without correction can accumulate failure, too — Philippines' long bureaucratic continuity did not deliver Korea-style upgrading.

SOURCES World Bank (1993, 2020, 2023); Maipose (2008); Svirydzenka & Petri (2014); ADB (2007); Hill (2013); IMF (1998, 1999); Statistics Botswana (2021). THEORY-002 approved claims.

The counterexamples change the answer — and so should the question.

WHAT THEY DO
They refuse the premise of the assigned title.

Botswana, Mauritius, Malaysia and the Philippines each take a slice of the “Africa failed, Asia succeeded” story and bend it. The question is no longer “why can’t Africa grow” but which combinations of history, policy and markets, in which case, produced which outcome.

Botswana · African, fast-growing

×15.9 · 1960→2020

Breaks: “African culture blocked growth.” Independence 1966 with 22 university graduates. Diamonds, prudence, public investment — not manufacturing deepening. GDP per capita 2020: US$6,254 (COVID year).

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID ASSET-PH-BWA-GABORONE-001 · Gaborone Bus Rank (Sarvesh Lutchmun, 2015, CC BY-SA 4.0)

Mauritius · African, diversified

×6.7

Breaks: “Africa cannot diversify out of commodities.” Sugar → EPZ textiles → tourism → finance. GDP per capita 2020: US$9,534. WGI Rule of Law 0.95.

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID ASSET-PH-MUS-MARKET-001 · Central Market, Port Louis (Didier Baertschiger, 2015, CC BY-SA 2.0)

Malaysia · Asian, FDI-led

×8.0 †

Breaks: “One Asian model.” Industrialised through multinational-led electronics; by 1992, ~90% of electronic products were made by TNC affiliates (World Bank, 2020).

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID ASSET-PH-MYS-PERAI-001 · Perai Free Industrial Zone (HundenvonPenang, 2024, CC BY-SA 4.0)

Philippines · Asian, slower

×2.85

Breaks: “Asia equals growth.” Only ≈2.85× in 60 years. Electronic products 58.2% of 2020 merchandise exports — without matching Korea-style deepening (Nasution, 2000).

EDITORIAL PLACEHOLDER — VERIFIED ASSET REQUIRED

ASSET ID ASSET-PH-PHL-MANILAPORT-001 · Port of Manila (Theurbanhistorian, 2009, CC BY-SA 3.0)

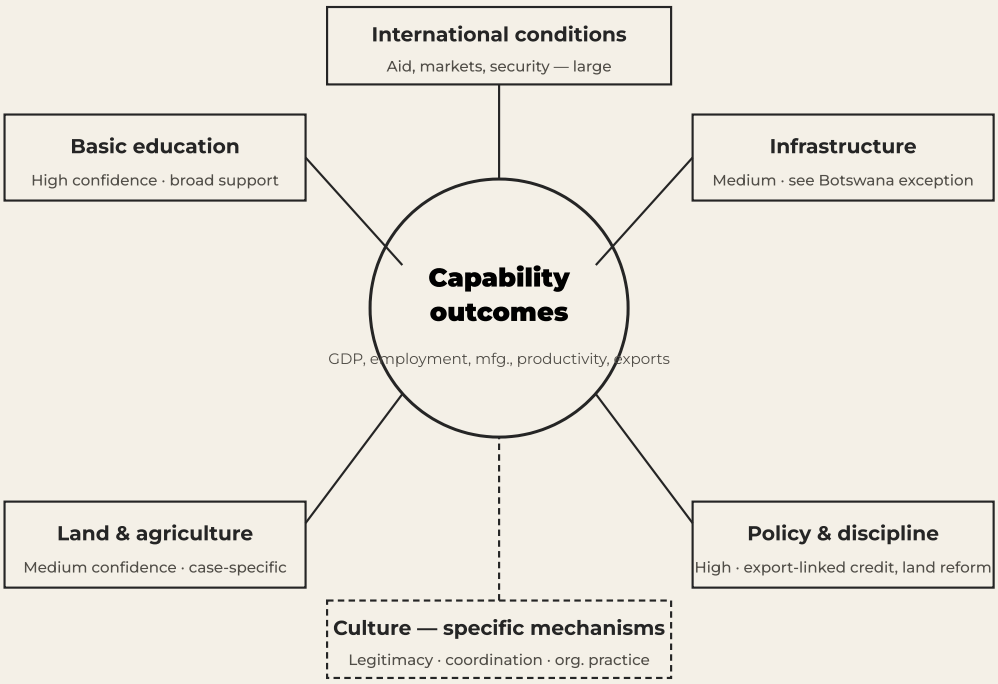
> **“If culture explains why Asia grew and Africa did not, Botswana and the Philippines are both inconvenient facts.”**
>
> — Editorial synthesis, drawing on THEORY-002 verdicts.

SOURCES WDI (2026); IMF (1998, 1999); Statistics Botswana (2021); World Bank (1997, 2020, 2023); Maipose (2008); Nasution (2000); Afrobarometer; Ipsos (Malaysia 2020). Images: Wikimedia Commons shortlist — placeholders in draft pending final asset selection, crop and credit approval.

What the combined evidence actually says.

FORM
Many forces, bounded confidence

Divergence depended less on fixed regional culture than on whether states, firms, workers and external partners built and disciplined productive capabilities over time. Culture may enter — through legitimacy, coordination, or organisational practice — but it must compete with non-cultural explanations. The constellation below is *not* a Venn diagram. It is a map of the forces whose interaction appears to matter, with each labelled by confidence and limitation.



WHERE CONFIDENCE IS HIGHEST
Basic education and policy / discipline — supported across Korea, Malaysia, Mauritius; absent or incomplete elsewhere.

WHERE CONFIDENCE IS LOWER
Infrastructure (Botswana exception), land & agriculture (case-specific), culture-as-mechanism (bounded to specific channels).

WHERE WE REMAIN SILENT
No ranking of relative weights. The evidence does not permit a universal weighting; it supports a bounded, case-by-case interpretation.

SOURCES Approved synthesis statement (ECON-001). RES-001, RES-002, ECON-001, THEORY-002. All country files: DATA-001 through DATA-005; master dataset DATA-008.

What can travel, what must adapt, what we do not claim.

RULE OF TRANSFER
Capabilities travel · copying rarely does.

Six cases, three ideas, and a careful record of what the evidence can and cannot support. Here is the three-column takeaway. Each item is reduced to a short claim and a short reason.

TRAVEL

BASIC EDUCATION FIRST
Universal literacy is a precondition for firm learning in every supporting case. Expensive, slow, cumulative.

POLICY WITH CORRECTION
Durable direction only pays when paired with performance feedback. Korea's HCI push was corrected; Marcos-era centralisation was not.

INSTITUTIONAL SUBSTITUTES
Business associations, courts, EPZ authorities can extend cooperation beyond close networks — the defensible "radius of trust."

ADAPT

EXPORT DISCIPLINES
Credit tied to export performance worked in Korea's context. Transplanting it needs a market, a currency regime, and an administration that can measure.

MINERAL-REVENUE STEWARDSHIP
Botswana shows it is possible; it depends on a particular bargain with the mining company and a civil service capable of saving.

EPZ DIVERSIFICATION
Mauritius shows the path across sugar / textile / tourism / finance; it depended on market access the next country may not have.

DO NOT CLAIM

CULTURE AS A SINGLE CAUSE
No cultural dimension alone identifies which case will grow. Hofstede dimensions are lenses, not fates.

AFRICA VS ASIA
Two blocs is not six cases. Both regions contain fast and slow growers.

SIX-COUNTRY TRUST RANKING
No matched evidence exists. "Trust rankings" based on WGI are not trust rankings.

> **"If culture matters, can culture change?"**

The closing question is on page 25. It is not rhetorical: Korea's policy environment, Mauritius' sector mix, and Botswana's stewardship each shifted across generations. The evidence we have supports the possibility that culture does change — because it already has.

NOTE Takeaways distilled from THEORY-002 verdicts and the approved synthesis statement. For each claim, see the matching page: education (p. 10), policy with correction (p. 21), institutional substitutes (p. 20).

Sources, credits, and a closing question.

TRANSPARENCY
Is part of the argument.

“If culture matters, can culture change?”

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FINAL NOTE Nothing in this magazine attempts to prove that six cases identify a cause. The strongest claim it makes is that “culture” explains the gap” fails to survive contact with six countries that all look different. The counterexamples remain the strongest teaching.